Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Chau and Hoang share an apartment. Their upstairs neighbor plays loud music every night.

Chau: It's two in the morning, and he's still at it!

Hoang: I can't **put up with** this anymore. I'm going up there.

Chau: Calm down. Remember last time? He **turned it down** for ten minutes, then right back up.

Hoang: Then I'll call the building manager. They can **look into** it.

Chau: Let's try to **sort it out** with him first. He's actually pretty nice.

Hoang: Nice? He **turned down** my invitation to the building barbecue.

Chau: Ha! So that's what this is really about.

Hoang: Maybe a little. Fine, I'll **bring it up** nicely. Over coffee.

Study Notes

It's two in the morning, and he's still at it!
Hai giờ sáng rồi mà anh ta vẫn chưa chịu thôi!
"be still at it" = vẫn đang làm việc gì đó (thường kéo dài, gây khó chịu).
Cách nói tương đương: He's still going!

So that's what this is really about.
À, hóa ra đây mới là lý do thật.
Dùng khi phát hiện ra động cơ thật đằng sau lời phàn nàn hay hành động của ai đó.
Cách nói tương đương: So that's the real reason!

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. I can't put up with this anymore.
change: "put_up_with" (t → d nhẹ)
strong: "can't", "anymore"

"put up with" nối liền thành "pu-đớp-wiđ": âm /t/ giữa hai nguyên âm đọc như "d" nhẹ. Nhấn "can't" và "anymore": đã hết chịu nổi.

2. He turned it down for ten minutes, then right back up.
linking: "turned_it_down"
change: "ten minutes" (n → m)
strong: "down", "back up"

"turned it down" nối liền: "tơrn-đi-đaon". "ten minutes" → "tem-mi-nits". Nhấn tiểu từ "down", "back up": chính chúng mang nghĩa.

3. Let's try to sort it out with him first.
change: "sort_it_out" (t → d nhẹ)
weak: "with him"
strong: "first"

Giọng Mỹ đọc "sort it out" như "sor-đi-đao": cả hai âm /t/ đều thành "d" nhẹ. "him" mất âm /h/: "with him" → "wi-đim".

• Cụm động từ tách được: tiểu từ (up, down, out) thường được nhấn: turn it DOWN, bring it UP.
• Đại từ "it" ở giữa đọc rất nhẹ và nối hai bên: sort it out → "sor-đi-đao".
• Âm /t/ giữa hai nguyên âm đọc như "d" nhẹ: put up → "pu-đớp".
• Âm /n/ trước /m/, /p/, /b/ biến thành /m/: ten minutes → "tem-mi-nits".

Grammar Focus

Cụm động từ tách được: turn down, sort out, bring up…

Danh từ đứng trước hay sau tiểu từ đều được: turn the music down / turn down the music. Đại từ (it, him…) phải đứng giữa: turn it down, không nói turn down it.

Could you **turn** the TV **down**?
She **turned down** the job offer.
Don't worry, I'll **sort it out**.

Cụm động từ không tách được: look into, put up with, deal with…

Tân ngữ, kể cả đại từ, luôn đứng sau cả cụm: look into it, put up with him; không chen vào giữa.

The police are **looking into** the case.
How do you **put up with** him?
I'll **deal with** it tomorrow.

Role Play track 27

A: It's two in the morning, and he's still at it!

B: I can't _____ this anymore. I'm going up there.

A: Calm down. Remember last time? He turned it down for ten minutes, then right back up.

B: Then I'll call the building manager. They can _____.

A: Let's try to sort it out with him first. He's actually pretty nice.

B: Nice? He turned down my invitation to the building barbecue.

A: Ha! So that's what this is really about.

B: Maybe a little. Fine, I'll _____ nicely. Over coffee.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. I can't put up with this anymore.
   a. deal with
   b. cope with
   c. stand

2. They can look into it.
   a. check it out
   b. sort it out
   c. have a word with him

3. Fine, I'll bring it up nicely.
   a. point it out
   b. mention it
   c. ask him